

BIHAR ORIGIN

Litti Chokha

Roasted Sattu-Stuffed Wheat Balls
with Smoky Mashed Vegetables

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

LICENSE & COPYRIGHT NOTICE

Litti Chokha

Sold via: Gumroad
Publisher: DhanioDigital (dhaniodigital.gumroad.com)

PERSONAL USE LICENSE

This digital cookbook is licensed for personal, non-commercial use only.
You may print one (1) copy for your own kitchen use.

YOU MAY NOT:

- Share, resell, or redistribute this file in any form
- Upload to any website, cloud service, or file-sharing platform
- Remove or obscure any watermarks, copyright notices, or branding
- Use recipes for commercial food service without written permission

Violation of this license may result in legal action.

© 2024 DhanioDigital. All rights reserved.
Contact: support@dhaniodigital.com

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Litti Chokha

AUTHOR

Sweta Verma

PUBLISHER

DhanioDigital

COPYRIGHT

© 2026 Sweta Verma. All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced or distributed without written permission from the publisher.

DISCLAIMER

Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

Bihar's Dish of Practicality and Pride

Litti chokha is, without much competition, Bihar's most iconic culinary export — a dish so identified with the state that it now appears on menus far beyond its borders, at Indian restaurants and food festivals across the country and increasingly abroad. At its heart it's a wheat dough ball stuffed with sattu (roasted gram flour), traditionally roasted directly over hot coals or dried cow-dung cakes until the outside turns deeply browned and slightly charred, then dipped in ghee and served alongside chokha, a smoky mash of roasted eggplant, tomato, and potato.

The dish's practicality shaped its history as much as its flavor. Litti travels well, doesn't spoil quickly, and its ingredients — wheat flour and roasted gram — were both affordable and readily available across rural Bihar, making it a natural choice for farmers, laborers, and travelers who needed food that could survive a long day away from home. Some food historians and popular tradition alike connect the dish to Bihar's long agricultural and martial history, imagining it as ideal traveling food for soldiers and pilgrims moving across the region, though this connection is more folklore than documented fact.

What began as humble, practical village food has since become a genuine point of regional pride, championed at Bihari food festivals and served at official state functions — proof that a dish born from necessity can become a defining cultural symbol.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

Bihar's Dish of Practicality and Pride, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

Widely considered Bihar's signature dish, now served at Indian restaurants and food festivals well beyond the state's borders. Traditionally roasted over coal or cow-dung cakes in rural kitchens, a method still used and prized for its distinct smoky flavor. Popularly associated with practicality and travel-friendliness, making it a natural choice for farmers, laborers, and travelers historically. A dish that has moved from humble village food to a genuine source of regional pride and identity.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

30m	30m	4	Med
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME	SERVINGS (8 LITTIS)	DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Mixing bowls
- Rolling pin — optional, for shaping
- Oven, or traditional coal/open flame setup
- Wire rack, for oven roasting
- Tongs, for traditional coal roasting

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Litti dough and filling can each be prepared a day ahead and refrigerated separately, assembled fresh before cooking. Cooked littis keep well at room temperature for a few hours, or refrigerated for 2 days — reheat in a warm oven to help restore some crispness. Chokha is best made fresh but keeps refrigerated for a day if needed.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the litti dough

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Whole wheat flour (atta)	2 cups	250 g	2 katori
Ajwain (carom seeds)	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Salt	½ tsp	3 g	to taste
Ghee	2 tbsp	30 g	2 chammach
Water, as needed	¾ cup approx.	180 ml approx.	¾ katori approx.

For the sattu filling

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Sattu (roasted gram flour)	1½ cups	180 g	1½ katori
Mustard oil	3 tbsp	45 ml	3 chammach
Ajwain (carom seeds)	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Nigella seeds (kalonji)	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Onion, finely chopped	1 small	80 g	1 small
Green chili, minced	2	2	2
Ginger-garlic paste	1 tbsp	15 g	1 chammach
Mango pickle (achaar) with its oil	1 tbsp	15 g	1 chammach
Fresh coriander, chopped	2 tbsp	8 g	2 tbsp

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

For the sattu filling (cont.)

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Lemon juice	1 tbsp	15 ml	1 chammach
Salt	¾ tsp	4.5 g	to taste
Water, as needed to bind	3–4 tbsp	45–60 ml	3–4 chammach

For serving

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Ghee, for dipping	4 tbsp	60 g	4 chammach

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

Sattu (roasted Bengal gram flour) is available at Indian grocers and increasingly online; make sure to get sattu specifically, not regular besan, as it's a distinct roasted product with a different flavor. Mango pickle adds a distinctive tang to the filling — any good quality Indian mango pickle works, or a squeeze of extra lemon juice as a simpler substitute. If you don't have access to coal or an open flame, this recipe includes a reliable oven method that still delivers excellent results.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Dough and Filling

01 MAKE THE LITTI DOUGH

Combine the whole wheat flour, ajwain, and salt. Rub in the ghee until the mixture resembles coarse crumbs, then gradually add water, kneading to a firm, smooth dough. Cover and rest for 20 minutes.

02 PREPARE THE SATTU FILLING

In a bowl, mix the sattu, mustard oil, ajwain, nigella seeds, chopped onion, green chili, ginger-garlic paste, mango pickle, coriander, lemon juice, and salt. Add water a tablespoon at a time until the mixture holds together when pressed but isn't wet or pasty.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

Making the Dough and Filling, continued



Chef tip. the filling should be crumbly and just barely holding together — too wet, and it will be difficult to stuff without tearing the dough.

COOKING CHECKPOINT

The sattu filling is ready when a small amount pressed in your palm holds its shape loosely without falling apart, but doesn't feel wet or sticky.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Stuffing & Roasting

03 STUFF THE DOUGH

Divide the dough into 8 balls. Flatten each into a small disc, place a generous spoonful of sattu filling in the center, then gather the edges up and around the filling, pinching to seal completely and rolling gently back into a smooth ball.

04 ROAST IN THE OVEN

Preheat your oven to 400°F / 200°C. Place the stuffed littis on a wire rack and roast for 30–35 minutes, turning occasionally, until deeply golden-brown and firm all over.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

Stuffing & Roasting, continued



05 OR ROAST OVER OPEN FLAME (TRADITIONAL METHOD)

For the traditional smoky flavor, roast the stuffed littis directly over hot coals or an open gas flame, turning frequently with tongs, until evenly charred and cooked through, about 15–20 minutes.

Color and texture indicator. a properly roasted litti should sound slightly hollow when tapped and show a deep, evenly browned crust — this confirms the inside has cooked through.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

Stuffing & Roasting, continued

06 DIP IN GHEE

While still hot, crack each litti slightly and dip it generously in melted ghee, letting it soak in — this step is essential to the dish's rich, traditional flavor.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Skipping the ghee dip is a common shortcut that misses the point of the dish entirely — the ghee soaking into the cracked, hot litti is what makes it rich and flavorful rather than dry.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served hot with chokha (mashed spiced eggplant, tomato, and potato) and a side of raw onion and green chili.
- Eaten by hand, breaking the litti apart and dipping into extra ghee and chokha.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Restaurant Presentation

- Served on a plate with chokha, a wedge of lemon, and a small bowl of ghee for dipping.

Family Style

- A shared platter of littis with a large bowl of chokha at the center, everyone serving themselves.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Filling Right

- A crumbly, well-seasoned filling with just enough moisture to hold together is the key technical challenge of this dish.
- The pickle in the filling isn't optional flavor — it's a defining component of authentic litti's tang.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- Both dough and filling can be made a day ahead and refrigerated, assembled and roasted fresh when ready to serve.
- Littis reheat reasonably well in a warm oven, making extras from a batch practical for a second meal.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Traditional roadside litti vendors often finish roasted littis by briefly pressing them between their palms to crack the crust before the ghee dip, maximizing how much ghee the interior can absorb.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

310 kcal	9 g	38 g	14 g	6 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with oil and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Dairy, Gluten, Mustard. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Litti with Chokha Trio	served with all three traditional chokhas — baingan (eggplant), aloo (potato), and tomato.
Stuffed Litti Variations	some households add crumbled paneer or extra vegetables to the sattu filling.
Litti Chaat	a modern street food twist, crumbled litti served chaat-style with chutneys and yogurt.

Can I make litti without an oven or open flame?

A stovetop method using a covered heavy pan on low heat, turning frequently, can work in a pinch, though the classic texture is best achieved with oven roasting or open flame.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Why did my litti crack or fall apart while roasting?

Usually the dough wasn't sealed completely around the filling, or the filling was too wet. Seal edges firmly and keep the filling crumbly rather than pasty.

What exactly is sattu?

Sattu is flour made from roasted Bengal gram (chana), distinct from regular besan, which is made from raw gram — it has a nutty, toasted flavor central to Bihari cuisine.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Sattu	roasted Bengal gram flour, the defining filling ingredient of litti.
Chokha	a mashed, smoky vegetable dish, the traditional accompaniment to litti.
Ajwain	carom seeds, used in both the dough and filling for their sharp aroma.
Achaar	Hindi for pickle, used in the filling for tang.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Litti Chokha

30m	30m
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME
4	**Med**
SERVINGS (8 LITTIS)	DIFFICULTY

LITTI DOUGH

Whole wheat flour	250 g
Ajwain	1.5 g
Salt	3 g
Ghee	30 g
Water	180 ml approx.

SATTU FILLING

Sattu	180 g
Mustard oil	45 ml
Ajwain	1.5 g
Nigella seeds	1.5 g
Onion	80 g
Green chili	2
Ginger-garlic paste	15 g
Mango pickle	15 g
Fresh coriander	8 g
Lemon juice	15 ml
Salt	4.5 g
Water	45–60 ml

FOR SERVING

Ghee	60 g

METHOD

01 **Make the litti dough.** Combine the whole wheat flour, ajwain, and salt.

02 **Prepare the sattu filling.** In a bowl, mix the sattu, mustard oil, ajwain, nigella seeds, chopped onion, green chili, ginger-garlic paste, mango pickle, coriander, lemon juice, and salt.

03 **Stuff the dough.** Divide the dough into 8 balls.

04 **Roast in the oven.** Preheat your oven to 400°F / 200°C.

05 **Or roast over open flame (traditional method).** For the traditional smoky flavor, roast the stuffed littis directly over hot coals or an open gas flame, turning frequently with tongs, until evenly charred and cooked through, about 15–20 minutes.

06 **Dip in ghee.** While still hot, crack each litti slightly and dip it generously in melted ghee, letting it soak in — this step is essential to the dish's rich, traditional flavor.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ Whole wheat flour	250 g	☐ Ajwain	see recipe
☐ Salt	see recipe	☐ Ghee	see recipe
☐ Sattu	180 g	☐ Mustard oil	45 ml
☐ Nigella seeds	1.5 g	☐ Onion	80 g
☐ Green chili	2	☐ Ginger-garlic paste	15 g
☐ Mango pickle	15 g	☐ Fresh coriander	8 g
☐ Lemon juice	15 ml		

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com